Khondoker Ittehadul Islam

+49 163 3705859 | khondoker.islam9@gmail.com | khondokerislam.github.io | KhondokerIslam | -kh | Google Scholar

Education

University of Groningen, Saarland University — *Groningen & Saarbrücken*

Double Degree Master's In LCT — *2024 - 2026 (Nov. expected)*

- CGPA in *German*: $1.7/4.0$
- Thesis: Unified Representational Analysis of Adaptation Methods. (*Proposal*:)

Shahjalal University of Science and Technology — *Sylhet, Bangladesh*

B.Sc. in Computer Science — *2017 - 2021*

- CGPA: $3.35/4.00$
- Thesis: Benchmarking Downstream Tasks for Low-Resource Language.

Skills

`Research Interest`	Interpretability, LM Architecture & Training, Biological Sequence Modeling
`Research Methods`	Probing & Representation Analysis, Causal Intervention, Benchmark Design, Ablation Study
`LLM & ML Frameworks`	PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, LoRA, LogitLens, scikit-learn, SciPy
`Programming & Tools`	Python, Git, Slurm, Bash, Seaborn, Biopython, LaTeX

Publications

- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Gabriele Sarti; Reveal-Bangla: A Dataset for Cross-Lingual Multi-Step Reasoning Evaluation; *BLP workshop @ IJCNLP-AACL 2025*.
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Tanvir Hossain Yuvraz, Md Saiful Islam, Enamul Hassan; EmoNoBa: A Dataset for Analyzing Fine-Grained Emotions on Noisy Bangla Texts; *AACL-IJCNLP 2022 Main*.
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Sudipta Kar, Md Saiful Islam, Mohammad Ruhul Amin; SentNoB: A Dataset for Analysing Sentiment on Noisy Bangla Texts; *EMNLP 2021 Findings*.
- **Khondoker Ittehadul Islam**, Md Saiful Islam, and Md Ruhul Amin; Sentiment analysis in Bengali via transfer learning using multi-lingual BERT; *ICCIT 2020*.

Professional Experience

2026 - now **Student Research Assistant**, MLT-Lab, DFKI

- Built a safety-evaluation pipeline for foundation models across different modalities.
- Developed reproducible LLM-as-a-Judge, robustness, and prompt-injection benchmarks.

2024 - 2025 **Student Research Intern**, InCLow Lab, University of Groningen

- Analyzed LLM reasoning via ContextCite attribution in a cross-lingual evaluation.
- Reported fixed reasoning pattern shared across languages regardless of resource level.
- Publication: BLP workshop @ IJCNLP-AACL 2025

2021 - 2024 **Software Engineer**, REVE Systems

- Digitalized a transport organization's administrative process in a cross-functional team.
- Incorporated Theory-of-Computation (ToC) concepts to automate its chain-of-decisions.
- Production: https://smart.dgt.gov.bd/login

Selected Research Projects

Autoregressive vs. Character Diffusion Language Models on OOV Text — *2026*

Saarland University — *Saarbrücken, Germany*

- Trained NanoGPT and Character Diffusion from scratch on a Reddit corpus.
- Reported higher offensive-class F1 for Character Diffusion on OLID.
- Code: github.com/KhondokerIslam/arlm-vs-dlm-on-oov

Evaluating Protein Language Models in Long Protein Sequence Generation — *2026*

Saarland University — *Saarbrücken, Germany*

- Evaluated SoTA PLM on long-sequence generation tasks (at least 1k amino acids).
- Observed random baselines to perform better.
- Report: khondoker/report/eval_cfpgen.pdf

OCR on Historical Documents *2025*

University of Groningen *Groningen, Netherlands*

- Improved linguistic capabilities of vLMs for OCR tasks.
- Composited image to augment ancient documents.
- Heuristically pseudo-labeled multi-class unlabeled documents.
- Report: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2508.10356

Fallacy Classification in Political Debates via CoT Prompting *2025*

University of Groningen *Groningen, Netherlands*

- Built CoT prompts (Pragma-Dialectics, Periodic Table) for Qwen-3 reasoning.
- Found added context often diluted, not aided, accuracy.
- Report: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2509.11127

Attributing LLM CoT Reasoning Answers *2025*

University of Groningen *Groningen, Netherlands*

- Applied ContextCite & Inseq to analyze CoT in Qwen2.5.
- Negation/distractors cut coherence & accuracy.
- Received *Best NLP Student Project Award*.
- Report: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2511.15886

Offensive Text Classification Leveraging Sentiment *2024*

University of Groningen *Groningen, Netherlands*

- Collected sentiment for each OLID instances using DeBERTa V3.
- Observed no positive-sentiment effect on offensive classification.
- Report: https://arxiv.org/pdf/2412.17825

Bachelor Thesis: Benchmarking Bangla Downstream Tasks *2020-2022*

Shahjalal University of Science & Technology *Sylhet, Bangladesh*

- Designed annotation and corpus quality metric for emotion and sentiment tasks.
- Showed Transformers underperform rule-based methods on morphologically rich instances.
- Publications: EMNLP 2021 Findings, AACL-IJCNLP 2022 Main, ICCIT 2020

Awards

2025 **Best NLP Student Project Award**, @GroNLP, University of Groningen
Won among seven student teams for analyzing LLM trustworthiness.

2025 **Google & Zendesk Scholarship**, LxMLS 2025
Funded attendance of the Lisbon Machine Learning Summer School.

2024 **NL Scholarship**, Nuffic, Dutch Ministry of Education, Culture, and Science
Awarded a stipend for my master's studies in the Netherlands.

2023 **Outstanding Reviewer**, BLP Workshop @ EMNLP 2023
Recognized for high-quality, constructive reviews.

2021 **Student Travel Scholarship**, EMNLP 2021
Funded travel to present my Findings paper.

Academia Services

2024-2025 **Programme Committee Member**, ReMa Linguistics, CLCG, University of Groningen
Represented the student cohort and advised on course structure.